

William C. Hernandez

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EDUCATION

University of Waikato

Hamilton, Waikato

Bachelor of Software Engineering with Honours

Expected Graduation, Nov 2028

- **Focus Areas:** AI, Cybersecurity, Embedded Systems, Full-Stack Development.
- **Extracurriculars:** Young Engineers Society (First-Year Student Rep), Waikato Astronautics Club (UWAC), Class Representative for 8 Papers, CS³ (Computer Science Club), MC² (Mathematics Club).

St. John's College

Hamilton, Waikato

NCEA Level 1, 2 and 3 Excellence Endorsement

Jan 2020 - Nov 2024

- **Leadership Role:** Arts Leader, Student Prefect, Student Volunteering Leader.

EXPERIENCE

AI Trainer · DataAnnotation (Freelance/Remote)

Apr 2026 - Present

- Designing complex tasks to train and identify vulnerabilities and weaknesses in LLMs.

Sessional Assistant · University of Waikato (Contract/On Site)

Mar 2026 - Present

- Facilitated technical labs for 50+ students learning to program in MATLAB and Python.
- Conducted live code reviews, evaluating algorithmic performance and structural integrity to provide actionable, real-time feedback to students.

Engineering Student Ambassador · University of Waikato (Contract/Outreach)

May 2025 - Present

- Representing the University of Waikato in Outreach programmes across the North Island related to Software Engineering.

ACTIVITIES & LEADERSHIP

University of Waikato Astronautics Club (UWAC)

General Executive (IT Admin), Marketing Assistant

2026 - Present

- **Firmware Engineering:** Developing and optimising flight computer firmware using C++ and Arduino to process high-frequency data and real-time telemetry. Gained familiarity with KiCAD and embedded systems to ensure low-latency hardware-software communication.
- **Information Security & IT Admin:** Managing ITAR-compliant data environments (SharePoint Infrastructure), ensuring strict access control and secure versioning for sensitive avionics information.
- **Full-Stack Engineering:** Developing a comprehensive redesign of the [uwac.nz](#) website, from a static hardcoded React codebase to a dynamic Next.js & Supabase stack. Implementing a relational database to handle member data and real-time activity.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Anatomy Explorer

Co-Developer · COMPM241 - Smoke & Mirrors

2026

- Created a 3D anatomical web application as a group using a React/Three.js framework.
- Developed dynamic scaling systems using OLS regression, and multiple interactive layers.

CampusBite - Find extra food on campus

Full-Stack Developer · UNIHACK AU/NZ Hackathon

2026

- Real-time peer-to-peer food networking application built on React using Firebase for live activity.
- Uses Gemini Vision API to recognise photos of food and precision matches to user dietary requirements. Features a secure claim system with pickup verification codes and user histories showcasing proficiency in handling in live, synchronised data streams.

HONOURS & AWARDS

Computer Science Undergraduate Scholarship · University of Waikato

2024

- Awarded to the top 10 students nationwide based on a rigorous CS examination and competition.

Ko te Tangata Scholarship · University of Waikato

2024

- Prestigious school-leaver award recognizing top-achieving academic students entering the university.

David Johnstone Charitable Trust Scholarship · Perpetual Guardian

2024

- Awarded to 20+ young people for demonstrating exceptional initiative, leadership, and ingenuity.

SKILLS

- **Proficient Languages:** Python, MATLAB, C++, Arduino, C#, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, Verilog.
- **Tools & Frameworks:** Git, Linux, Supabase (PostgreSQL), Firebase, Tailwind CSS, Shadcn/ui.
- **Core Concepts:** Object-oriented Programming, Machine Learning, Real-time Data Pipelines, Low-latency Logic, Data Synchronisation, State Machines, 3D Vector Math.